

Cambodia continues to have one of the worst records of corruption, human rights abuses, sexual exploitation of young girls, and HIV/AIDS in the world. Although still very poor and largely agricultural, the country has nevertheless experienced one of the world's highest growth rates since 2000, to the extent that it now meets the criteria to graduate from the United Nations' least-developed-country (LDC) category of nations.

International genocide tribunals have proceeded slowly, due to both financial reasons and a lack of commitment. Comrade Duch received a life sentence for crimes against humanity in 2012; Nuon Chea, Pol Pot's right-hand man, and Khieu Samphan, Pol Pot's successor as leader of the Khmer Rouge, were both arrested in 2007 and given life sentences in 2014. The only other trials were dropped, the first due to the defendant's death and the second due to dementia.

Lasting legacy in Laos

Since 2000, Laos has seen improvements in education and health care, and a steady reduction in poverty, but efforts to transform the largely agrarian country have recently stalled. High government borrowing to finance a rash of new infrastructure projects has caused spiraling inflation and widespread unemployment. Added to this, an estimated 30 percent of the two million tons of bombs dropped on the country during the war did not explode—leaving an estimated 78 million pieces of unexploded ordnance. More than 20,000 people have died from unexploded ordnance since the war's end.

